

Off the Shelf



Unreal Tournament 2003

Who needs reality?

The gods must love a franchise, there are so many of them. Welcome then, *Unreal Tournament 2003*, child of the much loved and much heaped with accolades, *Unreal Tournament*. The kid has grown up to be so much like, and yet a bit more than his father before him—we dare declare that *UT2003* is a gorgeous piece of software, that asks a gorgeous hardware price.

It has been moulded to feel like a sports game: the gameplay is faster, the weapons nicely balanced, the on-screen HUD is much cleaner and packs in a lot more information, and an annoying commentator completes the effect. There have been other non-cosmetic changes like the inclusion of special moves, the addition of weapons such as the Ion Painter and



GETTING THINGS RIGHT: Excellent level design and beautifully detailed player models add to the superior game play

the dropping of others like the razor-spewing Ripper. Sticking with the weapons, the sniper rifle now masquerades as the Lightning Gun which fires visible electric bolts,

a bane for camping snipers. Similarly balanced are the Flak Cannon, the Redeemer and the Minigun—note though that all of these still sport an alternate firing mode and are lots of fun to play with. Supporting the excellent level design are some new modes of fragging and scoring. Double Domination, for starters requires greater teamwork as you now need to hold two domination points simultaneously. Everybody's favourite mode, Assault has been removed to make way for Bombing Run, a Rugby-like addition that is a blast to play and will surely enter the good books of many.

Unreal Tournament 2003 is an enjoyable mix of both, the new and the familiar, and is a highly recommended buy, if your computer is up to the task.

Minimum system requirements: 733 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, 3D Accelerator card with 16 MB VRAM ■ **Genre:** First person shooter
Developer: Digital Extremes ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive Software Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614
Web site: www.unrealtournament2003.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,299 ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★

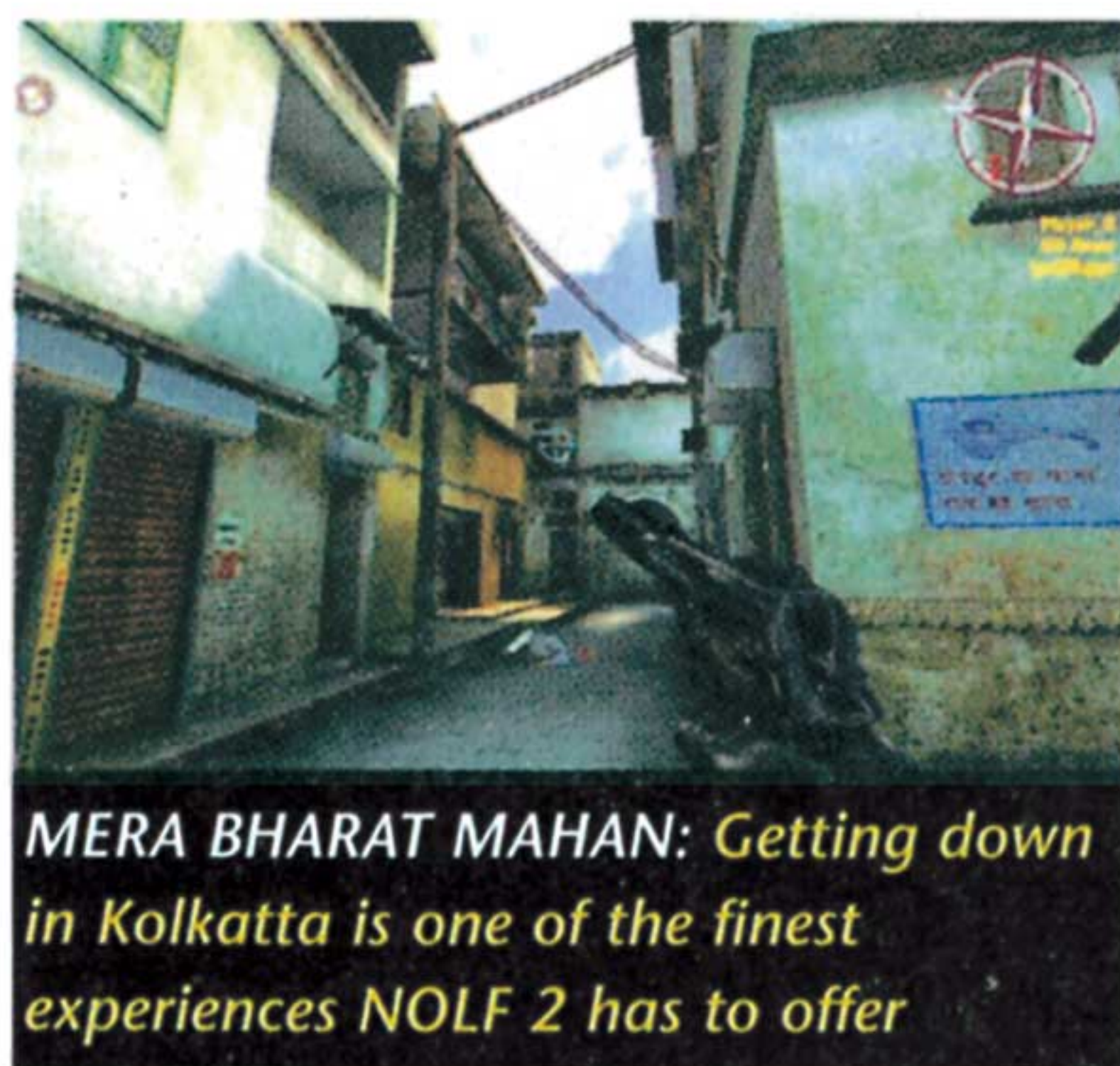


No One Lives Forever 2: A SPY IN H.A.R.M.'s WAY

Cate plays cupid

Monolith's *No One Lives Forever* (NOLF) is every bit as good as its prequel and then some. It stars Cate Archer, a spy with enough oomph to entice you, sophistication to disarm you and a bevy of whacky gadgets to incapacitate you.

The game is set in the sixties where Com-



MERA BHARAT MAHAN: Getting down in Kolkatta is one of the finest experiences NOLF 2 has to offer

hide more effectively in the shadows, be

munists abound, war is always around the corner and mimes have a tendency to shoot first and ask questions later. *NOLF 2* blends in the elements of action and stealth to great effect—you can reward points to skill sets that help define the heroine; these include stealth, search and weapons. As time progresses, Cate can

more successful in recovering valuable items whilst searching the bodies of fallen foes and be a better shot at moving targets. Weapons excel in both variety and the cool factor. You are thus likely to find in your possession a crossbow, a katana, shurikens, mascara that doubles up as a stun gun, a banana, a bear trap and an exploding kitten.

The icing on the cake is the excellent voice acting, a good story, vehicles and an excellent use of humour. *No One Lives Forever 2* is an experience that should not be missed, not this time.

Minimum system requirements: 500 MHz processor, 128 MB RAM, 3D Accelerator card with 32 MB VRAM ■ **Genre:** First person shooter
Developer: Monolith Productions ■ **Distributor:** World Wide CDROMS ■ **Phone:** 022-26973894/95
Web site: www.nolf2.sierra.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,299 ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★